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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: TEACHERS' RESEARCH ENGAGEMENT AND CHALLENGES: BASES FOR MENTORING PROGRAM	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation							
Municipality/City:	Tapaz						
Province:	Capiz						
Region:	VI						
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
Research:	Development:						
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing						
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization						

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(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization
(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.) (9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.) Abstract A nationwide initiative to encourage teacher research participation should start with defining the desired behaviors and the barriers. While most agree that the workforce lacks the skills required to adapt to the new curriculum, the nature of the 'need' is less clear, both in general and in connection to teacher research engagement. It's hardly surprising that the workforce isn't now demonstrating these behaviors. But it's unclear where they "fell short." It's also unclear how this affects the new curriculum's success. This study investigated the following questions: a. what is the demographic profile of teachers in terms of sex, age, length of service, and educational attainment? b. What is the level of teachers' research engagement in the areas of qualitative and quantitative research? c. What are the challenges of teachers in research in the areas of qualitative and quantitative research? d. What mentoring program will be formulated? This study is descriptive in nature. Data were collected from the 200 teachers from the Tapaz East and Tapaz West District, Division of Capiz, and were analyzed qualitatively. Results of the study revealed that 145, or 72.5 percent were young while 55 or 25.5 percent, were old. In terms of sex, 153 or 78 percent were female while 44 or 22 percent were male. In terms of length of service, 89, or 44.5 percent, were new, while 111, or 55.5 percent, were old. In terms of educational attainment, 125 or 62.5 percent were bachelor's degree holders, 55 or 27.5 percent were master's degrees, and 20 or 10 percent were Doctorate degree holders. In terms of the level of teachers' research engagement in the areas of qualitative research and quantitative research, 108 or 54 percent of the teachers were highly engaged; 67 or 33.5 percent of them were engaged; 20 or 10 percent were less engaged, and 5 or 2.5 percent were not engaged. The majority of the teacher respondents agreed that the challenges encountered according to rank: additional workload and burden on the part of the teacher (42%), lack of time (16.5%), writing anxiety (14.5%), lack of support from the school (9.5%), lack of sufficient reference materials (9%), and inadequate knowledge regarding the conduct of research (8.5%). Most of the respondents encountered challenges in conducting research, like the lack of time, had anxieties in writing and conducting the study, and perceived research as an additional burden on their part. Additionally, analyzing the quantitative and qualitative data in identifying the issues to be investigated has been a tough challenge for them as well. And so, the researcher of this study has made a mentoring program to resolve the challenges and difficulties experienced by the teachers who conducted the research and will be used by future teacher-researchers. Keywords: Engagement and challenges, descriptive, research, teacher-researchers, Philippines	
(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews). A nationwide initiative to encourage teacher research participation should start with defining the desired behaviors and the barriers. While most agree that the workforce lacks the skills required to adapt to the new curriculum, the nature of the 'need' is less clear, both in general and in connection to teacher research engagement. It's hardly surprising that the workforce isn't now demonstrating these behaviors. But it's unclear where they "fell short." It's also unclear how this affects the new curriculum's success (Tripney et.al, 2018). Mehrani (2015) examined teachers' research commitments to give light on whether, which, and when instructors employ educational research. This type of analysis is crucial to closing the research-practice divide because it allows us to study academic research discourse from the perspective of individuals who have been mostly excluded from it. When questioned about their research involvement, teachers frequently alluded to their university years and, most often, to term projects they had submitted to their instructors as part of their course requirements. Thus, teachers' positive responses to queries regarding their level of participation may not represent their current research activities but rather some academic rules and regulations. That is, teachers may have	

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studied or conducted research as part of their original teacher training or further degree courses, but not necessarily as teachers. This confirms that many teachers' research commitment ends with university graduation.

Although difficult, conducting research can help teachers improve their knowledge and skills. Teachers see research as a key tool in producing and delivering great learning outcomes to pupils. It is also useful and practical for both teachers and students. According to Ulla et al. (2017), completing research is crucial to professional progress. This allows them to investigate classroom and school problems and solutions while expanding their knowledge and skills for classroom teaching.

However, professors who enjoy research find it difficult to continue for numerous reasons. According to Ulla's research, here are key scientific problems in 2018: foremost, lack of school support in terms of finances, work, and training. Lack of reference materials refers to a lack of school library, other sources such as current periodicals and magazines, or even internet access. Third, due to increased effort and strain on teachers, performing research has become a burden and is treated less. One factor is nervousness about writing and lack of time. Fourth, lack of understanding about conducting action research due to others not being able to attend research training.

In this connection, the researchers probed to study the research engagement and challenges teachers encountered to be a basis for the mentoring program through an action plan as part of the recommendations. This study aimed to determine the level of teachers' engagement and the challenges in research as a basis for formulating mentoring program in the Capiz State University during the year 2022. Specifically, this study sought to answer the following questions:

1. What is the sociodemographic profile of the respondents in terms of sex, age, length of service and educational attainment?
2. What is the level of teachers' research engagement in the areas of qualitative and quantitative research?
3. What are the challenges of teachers in research in the areas of qualitative and quantitative research?
4. What mentoring program will be formulated?

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Methodology

This study employed a descriptive research method. According to McCombes (2020) descriptive research aims to describe a population, situation, or phenomenon accurately and systematically. Thus, the nature of the research investigation was a descriptive design, which used a researcher-made questionnaire validated by a panel of experts (Ysulan, 2021).

Participants

The respondents of this study were permanently employed teachers of Tapaz East and Tapaz West Districts, Schools Division of Capiz. To determine the number of actual respondents, they were purposively chosen. According to Arikunto (2010: 183), purposive sampling is the process of selecting a sample by taking a subject that is not based on the level or area but it is taken based on the specific purpose. Purposive sampling is where a researcher selects a sample based on the needs of the study. After a series of selections, 100 teachers from both districts were taken as respondents.

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(12) Results and Discussions (This part contains presentation of results (data) with reference to the table and figure, to be followed by discussion, with support of reviewed literature. Sequence shall be based on the objectives of the study. Tables are formatted without vertical lines. Horizontal lines are set at the top and bottom portions as well as below table headings and above major subdivisions. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Results

In terms of age, 145, or 72.5 percent, were young, while 55, or 25.5 percent, were old. In terms of sex, 153 or 78 percent were female, while 44 or 22 percent were male. In terms of length of service, 89, or 44.5 percent, were new, while 111, or 55.5 percent, were old. In terms of educational attainment, 125 or 62.5 percent were bachelor's degree holders, 55 or 27.5 percent were master's degrees, and 20 or 10 percent were Doctorate's degree holders.

In terms of the level of teachers' research engagement in the areas of qualitative research and quantitative research, 108 or 54 percent of the teachers were highly engaged; 67 or 33.5 percent of them were engaged; 20 or 10 percent were less engaged, and 5 or 2.5 percent were not engaged.

The majority of the teacher respondents agreed that the challenges encountered according to rank: additional workload and burden on the part of the teacher (42%), lack of time (16.5%), writing anxiety (14.5%), lack of support from the school (9.5%), lack of sufficient reference materials (9%), and inadequate knowledge regarding the conduct of research (8.5%).

Discussions

The results show that most of the teachers were highly engaged in areas of qualitative and quantitative research. This also shows that teachers were very committed to their profession and found research as a way of professional development. Tack and Vanderlinde (2014) reported that teacher commitment that they should engage in research promotes their research-related activity. This study reinforces the same proposition, particularly for those who have indicated active, continuous research engagement based on their commitment to the profession; conversely, those who were less committed to their profession were not actively engaged in research.

In terms of the challenges majority of the teachers ranked that conducting qualitative and quantitative research adds additional workload and burden on the part of the teacher. This result supports the study of Vásquez (2017) mentioned that heavy teaching loads are why teachers opted not to do research. As teachers compromise with priorities in their workplace, family, and society, they should be given quality time to do what they are expected to do. Furthermore, a lack of research training would affect the teachers' interest, confidence, and motivation to do research activities. Sheikh, Kaleem, and Waqas (2013) also noted that participation in research training and courses would positively impact the researchers as they would be exposed to different methodologies, styles, and concepts of doing research. Therefore, research training and seminars should be made available for all these teachers to acquire the necessary knowledge and learn the skills on how to do research. If teachers do not have the skills, they will not be able to carry out the task successfully (Ulla, 2016)

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.).

Conclusion:

The majority of the respondents were females, and bachelor's degree holders and their ages ranged from 30-40 years old. The teacher-researchers were challenged by the lack of time, experienced writing anxiety in conducting research, and viewed it as an additional workload and burden on their part. Furthermore, they also experienced difficulties in analyzing quantitative and qualitative data and identifying issues and problems to be investigated. A mentoring program should be proposed as a means of enhancing the teacher's prowess in research.

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Recommendations:

Teachers should be provided with adequate research seminars, training, and workshops, and they must attend these on a regular basis to acquire research skills and processes in order to produce quality research; School Heads and Administrators should extend their support to teachers by sending them to research seminars, training, workshops, and other activities designed to better prepare them to conduct research and develop a growth mindset of time management. Future Researchers should conduct further research related to this study to deepen the study to a different extent and to address specific research problems of classroom teachers mainly, and a mentoring program on research should be implemented to help teachers avoid problems in the future conduct of their research.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indentation with 12-point space in between.)

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